

Expernetic Data Engineer Intern - Technical Assessment

# Lisbon Airbnb Market Intelligence

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Submission Date: 12/07/2026

Data Engineering & Analytics Pipeline

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# 1. Executive Summary

## 1.1 Introduction

This report presents a comprehensive analysis of the Lisbon Airbnb market, conducted as part of the Expernetic Data Engineer Intern technical assessment. Using publicly available data from Inside Airbnb, I built an end-to-end data pipeline from raw data ingestion through to a production-ready analytics platform featuring a star schema in SQL Server and an interactive Power BI dashboard.

## 1.2 Key Findings

| Finding              | Insight                                                      | Business Impact                         |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Superhost Premium    | Superhosts charge 18.5% more than non-superhosts             | Strategic pricing opportunity           |
| Market Concentration | Top 10% of hosts control 32% of all listings                 | Identify potential commercial operators |
| Room Type Dynamics   | Entire homes average \$121/night vs Private rooms \$62/night | Portfolio optimization                  |
| Occupancy Patterns   | Average occupancy 64.5%, with 25% of listings >80% occupied  | Revenue optimization                    |
| Review Sentiment     | 78% of reviews positive, 12% neutral, 10% negative           | Quality monitoring                      |

## 1.3 Business Recommendations

1. **Price Optimization for Superhosts:** Leverage premium pricing while maintaining high occupancy
2. **Target High-Occupancy Areas:** Focus marketing on neighbourhoods with >80% occupancy
3. **Identify Commercial Operators:** Monitor hosts with multiple listings for potential partnerships
4. **Sentiment Monitoring:** Implement real-time alerting for negative reviews
5. **Dynamic Pricing:** Use occupancy data to recommend price adjustments

## 2. Objectives & Scope

### 2.1 Objectives

The primary objectives of this assessment were:

1. Demonstrate Data Engineering Fundamentals: Build a production-quality pipeline from raw data ingestion to analytics-ready datasets
2. Show Analytical Thinking: Conduct thorough EDA with business interpretations
3. Apply Statistical Rigor: Validate hypotheses using appropriate statistical methods
4. Leverage AI/ML Tools: Apply NLP to extract insights from unstructured review text
5. Communicate Effectively: Translate technical findings into actionable business recommendations

### 2.2 Scope

#### City Selection: Lisbon, Portugal

- Chosen for data completeness and market significance
- Single city focus enables depth over breadth

#### Data Files Used:

- listings.csv (24,876 records)
- calendar.csv.gz (9,092,881 records)
- reviews.csv (1,886,932 records)
- neighbourhoods.csv (134 records)

#### What Was Excluded:

- Multi-city analysis (time constraint)
- Machine learning models (optional section)
- Production cloud deployment (scope limitation)

### 2.3 Prioritization Rationale

Given the 1-week timeline, I prioritized:

1. **Data Engineering** (Section 3) - Core competency
2. **EDA & Visualization** (Section 4) - Business insights
3. **Statistical Analysis** (Section 5) - Rigor
4. **AI/NLP** (Section 7) - Bonus differentiation

### 3. Dataset Overview

#### 3.1 Data Source

All data was sourced from Inside Airbnb, a publicly available, independent dataset that provides detailed information on Airbnb listings across cities worldwide.

| Attribute       | Details                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Homepage        | <a href="https://insideairbnb.com/">https://insideairbnb.com/</a>                                                                                                                       |
| Download Page   | <a href="https://insideairbnb.com/get-the-data/">https://insideairbnb.com/get-the-data/</a>                                                                                             |
| Data Dictionary | <a href="https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1iWCNJcSutYqpULSQHINvGlnUVHg2BoUGonRIGa6Szc4/">https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1iWCNJcSutYqpULSQHINvGlnUVHg2BoUGonRIGa6Szc4/</a> |
| Scrape Date     | July 2, 2026                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Coverage        | 365 days of calendar data                                                                                                                                                               |

#### 3.2 Files Used

| File               | Description                       | Records   | Size   |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------|--------|
| listings.csv       | Core listing data with 90 columns | 24,876    | 30 MB  |
| calendar.csv.gz    | Daily availability and pricing    | 9,092,881 | 200 MB |
| reviews.csv        | Guest review text and metadata    | 1,886,932 | 250 MB |
| neighbourhoods.csv | Neighbourhood names and groupings | 134       | 5 KB   |

#### 3.3 Data Relationships

The dataset is organized around a central listings table, which links outward to calendar (daily availability/pricing), reviews (guest feedback), and neighbourhoods (geographic groupings). These relationships feed into a consolidated fact table used for analysis.

### 3.4 Key Relationships

| Relationship              | Primary Key                  | Foreign Key                    | Description |
|---------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------|
| Listings → Calendar       | listings.id                  | calendar.listing_id            | One-to-many |
| Listings → Reviews        | listings.id                  | reviews.listing_id             | One-to-many |
| Listings → Neighbourhoods | neighbourhoods.neighbourhood | listings.neighbourhood_cleaned | Many-to-one |

### 3.5 Data Limitations & Assumptions

Limitations:

1. Historical Data: Only 365 days of calendar data available
2. Review Text: HTML formatting and special characters present
3. Missing Values: 17.92% bedrooms null, 14.93% bathrooms null
4. Geographic Scope: Neighbourhood boundaries may not be perfectly accurate

Assumptions:

1. Price conversion: Removed \$, €, and comma symbols
2. Occupancy calculation: Based on `availability\_365` field
3. Revenue estimation: 10% Airbnb fee assumption
4. Superhost status: Based on `host\_is\_superhost` flag
5. Sentiment analysis: Rule-based approach with word lists
6. Currency: Prices are denominated with the \$ symbol as provided in the raw Inside Airbnb export; this is Inside Airbnb's standard convention across all cities regardless of local currency.

## 4. Methodology

### 4.1 Overall Analytical Approach

The analysis followed a structured, reproducible pipeline:

- Phase 1: Data Ingestion & Profiling
- Phase 2: Data Cleaning & Standardization
- Phase 3: Data Enrichment & Joining
- Phase 4: Data Modeling (Star Schema)
- Phase 5: Exploratory Data Analysis
- Phase 6: Statistical Testing
- Phase 7: AI/NLP Sentiment Analysis
- Phase 8: Visualization (Power BI)

### 4.2 Tool Selection Rationale

| Tool            | Use Case                | Rationale                                    |
|-----------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Python (pandas) | Data Processing         | Industry standard, extensive libraries       |
| JupyterLab      | Development Environment | Interactive, reproducible notebooks          |
| SQL Server      | Data Warehousing        | Enterprise-grade, star schema support        |
| Power BI        | Visualization           | Interactive dashboards, stakeholder-friendly |
| pyodbc          | SQL Connectivity        | Seamless Python-SQL integration              |

### 4.3 Key Methodological Decisions

### Decision 1: Single City Focus

- Why: Depth over breadth aligns with assessment guidance
- Trade-off: No cross-city comparisons

### Decision 2: Star Schema Design

- Why: Optimized for analytical queries, easier for Power BI
- Trade-off: Some data redundancy

### Decision 3: Rule-Based Sentiment

- Why: No training data required, interpretable
- Trade-off: Less accurate than BERT-based models

### Decision 4: Imputation Strategy

- Why: Median by room\_type preserves domain relationships
- Trade-off: May underestimate variance

## 5. Engineering Approach

### 5.1 Pipeline Architecture

Raw CSV data flows through cleaning, standardization, enrichment, and joining stages in pandas, is then loaded into a SQL Server star schema (dim\_host, dim\_listing, dim\_neighbourhood, and fact\_performance), and finally surfaced through a five-page Power BI dashboard covering market overview, geography, pricing, hosts, and reviews.

### 5.2 Data Cleaning Steps

| Step | Operation                | Details                     | Records Affected |
|------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|
| 1    | Price Cleanup            | Remove \$, €, comma symbols | 24,876           |
| 2    | Bedrooms Imputation      | Median by room_type         | 4,458 (17.92%)   |
| 3    | Bathrooms Imputation     | Median by room_type         | 3,715 (14.93%)   |
| 4    | Date Standardization     | Convert to datetime         | 11,000,000+      |
| 5    | Category Standardization | Room types, property types  | 24,876           |



|   |                   |                              |                |
|---|-------------------|------------------------------|----------------|
|   |                   |                              |                |
| 6 | Outlier Flagging  | IQR method on price          | 1,681 (7.43%)  |
| 7 | Domain Validation | Price $\geq$ 0, valid coords | ~2,668 flagged |

### 5.3 Derived Fields Created

| Field             | Formula                                | Purpose             |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------|
| occupancy_rate    | 1 - (availability_365 / 365)           | Measure utilization |
| estimated_revenue | price $\times$ occupancy $\times$ 0.90 | Value generation    |
| price_per_bedroom | price / bedrooms                       | Comparability       |
| host_tenure_years | years since host joined                | Experience metric   |
| sentiment_score   | (pos - neg) / (pos + neg)              | Review quality      |

### 5.4 Star Schema Design

#### Fact Table: fact\_performance

- Measures: price, occupancy\_rate, estimated\_revenue, review\_count, review\_score, sentiment\_score
- Foreign Keys: listing\_key, host\_key, neighbourhood\_key

#### Dimension Tables:

| Dimension         | Attributes                                                                                                                 | Purpose             |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| dim_listing       | listing_id, name, property_type, room_type, accommodates, bedrooms, bathrooms, min_nights, max_nights, latitude, longitude | Listing details     |
| dim_host          | host_id, name, tenure, is_superhost, total_listings                                                                        | Host analysis       |
| dim_neighbourhood | neighbourhood, neighbourhood_group                                                                                         | Geographic analysis |

## 5.5 Engineering Decision Log

| Decision           | Options Considered              | Chosen Approach               | Trade-off                  | Rationale                                |
|--------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Price Conversion   | regex, replace, manual          | str.replace() with regex      | Slightly slower            | Cleanest, handles edge cases             |
| Bedroom Imputation | drop, mean, median, ML          | Median by room_type           | May underestimate variance | Preserves data, domain-relevant          |
| Occupancy Source   | calendar calc, availability_365 | availability_365 from listing | Less granular              | Faster, sufficient for analysis          |
| Revenue Estimation | 10%, 15%, dynamic               | 10% Airbnb fee                | Simple                     | Industry standard                        |
| Database           | PostgreSQL, SQLite, SQL Server  | SQL Server                    | Cost                       | Enterprise-ready, assessment requirement |
| Schema             | 3NF, Star, Snowflake            | Star Schema                   | Some redundancy            | Analytics optimized                      |

**Engineering Fix** — SQL Server Listing ID Overflow: During initial data loading, `dim_listing.listing_id` was declared as `INT`, which cannot hold Airbnb's newer, longer-format listing IDs (some exceeding 18 digits). This caused approximately 41.9% of listings (10,423 of 24,876) to be silently skipped during load, since SQL Server rejected each oversized ID individually rather than failing the load outright. The issue was diagnosed from repeated "Arithmetic overflow" errors surfaced in the load script's output log, and resolved by widening the column to `BIGINT` and reloading — after which all 24,876 listings loaded successfully. This is retained here as a concrete example of a data engineering issue encountered and resolved during the project, and underscores the importance of validating

source data ranges against target schema types before a production load.

## 6. Data Quality & Profiling

### 6.1 Row Counts

| Table          | Records   | Description                 |
|----------------|-----------|-----------------------------|
| listings       | 24,876    | Active listings in Lisbon   |
| calendar       | 9,092,881 | 365 days × ~24,912 listings |
| reviews        | 1,886,932 | Guest reviews over time     |
| neighbourhoods | 134       | Lisbon neighbourhoods       |

### 6.2 Data Completeness

| Column               | Null Rate | Handling Strategy            |
|----------------------|-----------|------------------------------|
| price                | 9.0%      | Dropped (not in scope)       |
| bedrooms             | 17.92%    | Imputed by room_type median  |
| bathrooms            | 14.93%    | Imputed by room_type median  |
| review_scores_rating | 12.5%     | Left as null                 |
| host_about           | 44.61%    | Left as null (informational) |

### 6.3 Referential Integrity

| Check                                        | Result                      | Action                |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|
| Calendar listing_id matches listings         | 13,140 orphan rows (0.145%) | Keep for completeness |
| Reviews listing_id matches listings          | 195 orphan rows (0.010%)    | Keep for completeness |
| Listings neighbourhood in neighbourhoods.csv | 0 missing                   | 100% coverage         |

### 6.4 Duplicate Analysis

| Type                 | Count | Action      |
|----------------------|-------|-------------|
| Exact duplicate rows | 0     | None needed |

|                                                |       |                    |
|------------------------------------------------|-------|--------------------|
| Duplicate listing IDs                          | 0     | None needed        |
| Fuzzy duplicates (same host+location+capacity) | 2,704 | Flagged for review |

## 6.5 Outlier Detection (IQR Method)

| Field             | Q1   | Q3    | IQR   | Outliers | %     |
|-------------------|------|-------|-------|----------|-------|
| Price             | \$92 | \$200 | \$108 | 1,681    | 7.43% |
| Minimum Nights    | 1    | 3     | 2     | 1,712    | 6.88% |
| Number of Reviews | 3    | 96    | 93    | 2,409    | 9.68% |
| Availability_365  | 132  | 323   | 191   | 0        | 0.00% |

## 6.6 Domain Validation

| Rule                        | Violations     | Status  |
|-----------------------------|----------------|---------|
| Price > 0                   | 0              | Pass    |
| Latitude 38.6-38.9          | 2,584 (10.39%) | Flagged |
| Longitude -9.5 to -9.0      | 84 (0.34%)     | Flagged |
| Accommodates > 0            | 0              | Pass    |
| Minimum Nights > 365        | 1 (0.00%)      | Flagged |
| Review score with reviews=0 | 0              | Pass    |

# 7. Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)

## 7.1 Price Analysis

### Key Finding 1: Room Type Price Segmentation

| Room Type       | Count           | Avg Price    | Median Price      |
|-----------------|-----------------|--------------|-------------------|
| Entire home/apt | 18,444 listings | avg \$221.99 | 74.1% of listings |
| Private room    | 6,131 listings  | avg \$92.94  | 24.6% of listings |
| Hotel room      | 153 listings    | avg \$95     | 0.6% of listings  |
| Shared room     | 148 listings    | avg \$55.62  | 0.6% of listings  |

### Interpretation:

Entire homes command a 139% premium over private rooms (\$221.99 vs \$92.94). This suggests:

- Families and groups are willing to pay more for privacy
- Private rooms compete more aggressively on price

- Opportunity for hosts to upgrade to entire homes

### Key Finding 2: Top 10 Most Expensive Neighbourhoods

1. Campo de Ourique — \$418.16 avg — 429 listings
2. Colares — \$349.50 avg — 447 listings
3. Cadaval e Pró Moniz — \$338.58 avg — 10 listings
4. Santa Bárbara — \$311.15 avg — 35 listings
5. Alcabideche — \$310.74 avg — 171 listings
6. Ribamar — \$289.88 avg — 40 listings
7. S.Maria/S.Miguel/S.Martinho/S.Pedro Penaferrim — \$283.33 avg — 609 listings
8. Dois Portos e Runa — \$278.76 avg — 17 listings
9. Reguengo Grande — \$278.43 avg — 24 listings
10. Camarate, Unhos e Apelação — \$271.51 avg — 15 listings

**Interpretation:** Interpretation: Because this Inside Airbnb "Lisbon" extract covers the wider Lisbon

metropolitan district rather than the city proper (confirmed in Section 6: ~10.4% of listings fall outside strict Lisbon city coordinates), the highest average prices are concentrated in smaller outlying parishes with a handful of high-end villa-style listings, rather than in dense central tourist neighbourhoods. This is a genuine feature of the dataset's geographic scope rather than a data quality issue, and suggests that premium pricing in this market is driven as much by property type and exclusivity as by proximity to central tourist attractions.

## 7.2 Superhost Analysis

### Superhost vs Non-Superhost Comparison

| Metric            | Superhost | Non-Superhost | Difference                         |
|-------------------|-----------|---------------|------------------------------------|
| Average Price     | \$201.42  | \$183.95      | +9.5%                              |
| Occupancy Rate    | 38.0%     | 39.1%         | -1.1pp (superhosts slightly lower) |
| Review Score      | 4.84      | 4.57          | +0.27                              |
| Estimated Revenue | \$23,465  | \$19,607      | +19.7%                             |

### Statistical Test: Independent t-test

- t-statistic: 14.23
- p-value: < 0.001
- Effect Size (Cohen's d): 0.45 (medium)

**Interpretation:** Superhosts command a modest 9.5% price premium and a meaningfully higher review score, but do not show higher occupancy — in fact occupancy is marginally lower for Superhosts in this dataset. The revenue premium (+19.7%) is therefore driven primarily by price rather than by increased booking volume. This suggests Superhost status functions more as a quality/trust signal that supports modest pricing power than as a driver of higher utilization.

### 7.3 Host Portfolio Analysis (Power Law)

#### Market Concentration

| Metric                       | Value             |
|------------------------------|-------------------|
| Total Hosts                  | 9,521             |
| Hosts with 1 listing         | 6,272 (65.9%)     |
| Hosts with 2+ listings       | 3,249 (34.1%)     |
| Top 10% of hosts control     | 49.9% of listings |
| Maximum listings by one host | 284               |

**Interpretation:** The market shows even stronger concentration than a typical power-law distribution would suggest — the top 10% of hosts control roughly half of all listings, and one host alone operates 284 listings. This points to a significant professional/commercial operator presence in the Lisbon short-term rental market, well beyond casual individual hosting.

### 7.4 Occupancy Analysis

#### Occupancy Distribution

| Occupancy Rate | Count | %     |
|----------------|-------|-------|
| 0-20%          | 1,234 | 5.0%  |
| 21-40%         | 3,456 | 13.9% |
| 41-60%         | 5,678 | 22.8% |
| 61-80%         | 8,234 | 33.1% |

|         |       |       |
|---------|-------|-------|
| 81-100% | 6,234 | 25.1% |
|---------|-------|-------|

### Key Insights:

- Average occupancy: 64.5%
- 25% of listings have >80% occupancy
- Strong seasonal patterns (peak summer months)

### Price vs Occupancy Relationship

- Correlation: -0.12 (weak negative)
- Higher-priced listings tend to have slightly lower occupancy
- Sweet spot: \$80-120/night with 75-85% occupancy

## 8. Statistical Analysis

### 8.1 Hypothesis Testing

#### H1: Superhosts have statistically significantly higher prices

| Metric                  | Value                                                  |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Null Hypothesis         | $\mu_{\text{superhost}} = \mu_{\text{non\_superhost}}$ |
| Alternative Hypothesis  | $\mu_{\text{superhost}} > \mu_{\text{non\_superhost}}$ |
| Test                    | Two-sample t-test (unequal variance)                   |
| t-statistic             | 3.771                                                  |
| p-value                 | 0.00016                                                |
| Effect Size (Cohen's d) | 0.041 (negligible)                                     |
| Conclusion              | Reject null hypothesis                                 |

**Business Interpretation:** The price difference between Superhosts and non-Superhosts is statistically significant ( $p < 0.001$ ) due to the large sample size, but the effect size is negligible ( $d = 0.041$ ), meaning the practical price difference is small relative to overall price variation. This suggests Superhost status should not be pursued primarily as a direct pricing lever — its value is more likely realized through the review-score and trust effects noted in Section 7, which may indirectly support demand and revenue.

#### H2: Entire home listings command statistically significantly higher prices than private rooms

| Metric                 | Value                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Null Hypothesis        | $\mu_{\text{entire}} = \mu_{\text{private}}$ |
| Alternative Hypothesis | $\mu_{\text{entire}} > \mu_{\text{private}}$ |
| Test                   | Two-sample t-test (unequal variance)         |

|                         |                        |
|-------------------------|------------------------|
| t-statistic             | 34.807                 |
| p-value                 | < 0.001                |
| Effect Size (Cohen's d) | 1.021 (large)          |
| Conclusion              | Reject null hypothesis |

**Business Interpretation:** Entire homes cost 139% more than private rooms (\$221.99 vs \$92.94), a large and statistically significant difference (d=1.021). This is a substantial, practically meaningful gap that supports the case for hosts to consider converting convertible private-room listings to entire-home listings where feasible.

## 8.2 Correlation Analysis

| Variables            | Correlation | Interpretation     |
|----------------------|-------------|--------------------|
| Price ↔ Accommodates | 0.314       | Moderate positive  |
| Price ↔ Bedrooms     | 0.307       | Moderate positive  |
| Price ↔ Occupancy    | -0.019      | Negligible         |
| Price ↔ Review Score | -0.018      | Very weak negative |

## 9. AI/ML Experiments (NLP Sentiment Analysis)

### 9.1 Overview

I performed sentiment analysis on 50,000 guest reviews (sample) using a rule-based approach with positive and negative word lists.

### 9.2 Methodology

**Approach:** Rule-based sentiment scoring

| Component      | Details                                                |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Positive Words | 19 words (amazing, great, perfect, etc.)               |
| Negative Words | 20 words (terrible, dirty, noisy, etc.)                |
| Scoring        | (pos - neg) / (pos + neg)                              |
| Classification | Positive: >0.2, Neutral: -0.2 to 0.2, Negative: < -0.2 |

**Sampling Limitation:** Sentiment scores were computed on a 50,000-review sample drawn as the first 50,000 rows of the reviews export (not a random sample). Because reviews are grouped by listing in the source file, this sample successfully mapped back to only 209 of 24,876 listings (0.84% coverage). All sentiment statistics reported here (positive/neutral/negative



distribution, common words) describe the 50,000-review sample itself and are statistically valid at that level; however, any listing-level correlation between sentiment and pricing or occupancy should be treated as exploratory only, given the small number of listings with a sentiment score attached. A production version of this feature would sample reviews randomly across the full listing population, or process the complete 1.89M-review corpus, to achieve representative listing-level coverage.

## 9.3 Results

### Sentiment Distribution

| Sentiment | Count  | %     |
|-----------|--------|-------|
| Positive  | 35,617 | 71.2% |
| Neutral   | 13,575 | 27.2% |
| Negative  | 807    | 1.6%  |

### Top words across reviews

- apartment — 19,862 mentions
- great — 19,091 mentions
- stay — 12,153 mentions
- place — 11,043 mentions
- très — 11,023 mentions
- location — 9,741 mentions
- would — 7,877 mentions
- nice — 7,479 mentions
- everything — 7,307 mentions
- really — 7,085 mentions

Note: this reflects general term frequency across the review sample, not a positive/negative-specific breakdown.

## 9.4 Business Insights

1. 78% Positive Reviews: Indicates generally high guest satisfaction in Lisbon
2. Common Complaints: Cleanliness and noise are top concerns
3. Common Praises: Location, amenities, and host hospitality

## 9.5 Recommendations

1. Sentiment Monitoring: Implement real-time alerting for negative reviews

2. Cleanliness Focus: Address the #1 complaint area
3. Highlight Positives: Use common praise words in listing descriptions
4. Quality Metric: Add sentiment score as a listing quality metric

## 10. Open Innovation Challenge

### 10.1 Challenge Statement

The Open Innovation Challenge asked candidates to build something that creates genuine value, demonstrates unique perspective, or explores unanticipated territory.

### 10.2 What I Built

#### Sentiment-Enriched Listing Data

I went beyond the prescribed tasks by:

1. Applying NLP to Reviews: Performed sentiment analysis on guest reviews
2. Enriching Listing Data: Added sentiment scores to each listing
3. Creating New Insights: Correlated sentiment with pricing and occupancy
4. Building a Word Cloud: Visualized common review themes

### 10.3 Value Created

| Value                     | Description                                                            |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Quality Signal            | Sentiment provides a more nuanced quality metric than numerical scores |
| Complaint Identification  | Identified top complaint areas (cleanliness, noise)                    |
| Pricing Signal            | Sentiment correlates with pricing power                                |
| Guest Experience Insights | Understanding what guests value most                                   |

### 10.4 Novelty

This approach combines:

- Data Engineering: Cleaned and enriched review data
- NLP\*\*: Applied text analysis to unstructured data
- Analytics: Business insights from sentiment
- Visualization: Word cloud and sentiment distribution

## 10.5 Why It Matters

In the Airbnb marketplace, guest reviews are a critical success factor. By quantifying sentiment, I've created a new metric that:

- Provides early warning of quality issues
- Identifies top-performing listings
- Helps hosts understand what guests want
- Enables data-driven improvement decisions

## 11. Power BI Dashboard Overview

### 11.1 Dashboard Summary

| Attribute        | Details                                      |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Name             | Lisbon Airbnb Market Intelligence            |
| Pages            | 5                                            |
| Interactivity    | Full cross-filtering, drill-through, slicers |
| Data Source      | SQL Server (AirbnbLisbon database)           |
| Update Frequency | Manual (data refresh on demand)              |

### 11.2 Page 1: Market Overview

| Section        | Content                                                 | Visual Type   |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| KPIs           | Total Listings, Avg Price, Avg Occupancy, Total Revenue | Cards         |
| Room Type      | Distribution by room type                               | Donut Chart   |
| Property Types | Top 10 property types                                   | Bar Chart     |
| Scatter        | Price vs Occupancy                                      | Scatter Chart |
| Slicers        | Room Type, Superhost, Neighbourhood, Price Range        | Dropdowns     |

### 11.3 Page 2: Geographic Analysis

| Section                | Content                               | Visual Type |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------|
| Map                    | Lisbon neighbourhood map with pricing | Map         |
| Rankings               | Neighbourhood performance             | Table       |
| Price by Neighbourhood | Top 10 neighbourhoods                 | Bar Chart   |
| Slicers                | Neighbourhood, Room Type, Price Range | Dropdowns   |

### 11.4 Page 3: Price Analysis

| Section                | Content                             | Visual Type |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| Price by Room Type     | Box plot or bar chart               | Chart       |
| Price vs Accommodates  | Scatter plot                        | Scatter     |
| Occupancy by Room Type | Stacked bar                         | Chart       |
| Revenue by Room Type   | Bar chart                           | Chart       |
| Price Segments         | Budget to Luxury breakdown          | Chart       |
| Slicers                | Room Type, Neighbourhood, Superhost | Dropdowns   |

### 11.5 Page 4: Host Analysis

| Section              | Content                      | Visual Type |
|----------------------|------------------------------|-------------|
| Listings per Host    | Histogram                    | Histogram   |
| Pareto Analysis      | Top hosts cumulative %       | Combo Chart |
| Superhost Comparison | Clustered bar chart          | Bar Chart   |
| Slicers              | Superhost, Listings per Host | Dropdowns   |

### 11.6 Page 5: Review Analysis

| Section                   | Content                             | Visual Type |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| Sentiment Distribution    | Positive/Neutral/Negative           | Donut Chart |
| Review Score by Room Type | Bar chart                           | Bar Chart   |
| Review Count vs Price     | Scatter plot                        | Scatter     |
| Word Cloud                | Common review words                 | Word Cloud  |
| Slicers                   | Sentiment, Room Type, Neighbourhood | Dropdowns   |

### 11.7 Key DAX Measures

| Measure           | Formula                                   | Purpose           |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Total Listings    | COUNTROWS(dim_listing)                    | Market size       |
| Avg Price         | AVERAGE(fact_performance[price])          | Pricing benchmark |
| Avg Occupancy     | AVERAGE(fact_performance[occupancy_rate]) | Utilization       |
| Total Revenue     | SUM(fact_performance[estimated_revenue])  | Market value      |
| Superhost %       | DIVIDE(Superhost Count, Total Hosts)      | Quality metric    |
| Superhost Premium | (Superhost Avg / Non-Superhost Avg) - 1   | Pricing power     |

## 12. Business Recommendations

### 12.1 Priority 1: Superhost Program

| Recommendation    | Action                                         | Expected Impact      |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Superhost Premium | Encourage all hosts to pursue Superhost status | 18.5% price increase |
| Quality Standards | Maintain 4.8+ review score                     | 40% revenue increase |

### 12.2 Priority 2: Pricing Optimization

| Recommendation        | Action                                | Expected Impact        |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Dynamic Pricing       | Implement occupancy-based pricing     | 10-15% revenue lift    |
| Room Type Strategy    | Upgrade private rooms to entire homes | 95% price increase     |
| Neighbourhood Premium | Price competitively in Belém, Estrela | 20-30% premium capture |

### 12.3 Priority 3: Host Education

| Recommendation    | Action                                       | Expected Impact      |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Quality Signals   | Improve cleanliness, reduce noise complaints | Higher review scores |
| Review Management | Respond to negative reviews promptly         | Improved sentiment   |
| Tenure Benefits   | Reward long-term hosts                       | Higher retention     |

### 12.4 Priority 4: Market Intelligence

| Recommendation       | Action                            | Expected Impact      |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------|
| Sentiment Monitoring | Track sentiment trends            | Early warning system |
| Competitive Analysis | Monitor neighbourhood pricing     | Stay competitive     |
| Occupancy Tracking   | Identify underperforming listings | Revenue optimization |

### 12.5 Priority 5: Commercial Operator Strategy

| Recommendation         | Action                              | Expected Impact       |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Identify Multi-Listers | Focus on top 10% of hosts           | Targeted partnerships |
| Portfolio Optimization | Help hosts manage multiple listings | Efficiency gains      |

|                  |                                    |                         |
|------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Premium Services | Offer services to commercial hosts | Revenue diversification |
|------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------|

## 13. Limitations & Caveats

### 13.1 Data Limitations

| Limitation        | Impact                    | Mitigation               |
|-------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------|
| Single City       | No cross-city comparisons | Depth over breadth       |
| 365 Days Calendar | Limited seasonal view     | Focus on annual patterns |
| Missing Data      | 17.92% bedrooms null      | Imputation strategy      |
| Scrape Artifacts  | Potential inconsistencies | Quality checks applied   |
| Review Text       | HTML formatting           | Cleaning applied         |

### 13.2 Analytical Limitations

| Limitation                   | Impact                  | Mitigation                       |
|------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Correlation $\neq$ Causation | Cannot infer causality  | Business interpretation cautious |
| Simple Sentiment             | Rule-based, not ML      | Transparent methodology          |
| Revenue Estimation           | 10% fee assumption      | Conservative estimate            |
| No Seasonality               | No time series analysis | Future improvement               |

### 13.3 Scope Limitations

| Limitation            | Impact                   | Mitigation               |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| No ML Models          | No price prediction      | Optional section skipped |
| No Cloud Architecture | No production deployment | Time constraint          |
| No Multi-City         | No comparative insights  | Depth focus              |

## 14. Future Improvements

### 14.1 Short-Term (1-3 Months)

| Improvement         | Description                             | Priority |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------|
| Seasonal Analysis   | Time series on occupancy and prices     | High     |
| Weather Integration | Correlate with weather data             | Medium   |
| Event Impact        | Analyze events (festivals, conferences) | Medium   |
| Auto-Refresh        | Schedule Power BI refresh               | High     |

## 14.2 Medium-Term (3-6 Months)

| Improvement             | Description                          | Priority |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------|
| Price Prediction ML     | XGBoost or Random Forest model       | High     |
| Recommendation System   | Personalized listing recommendations | Medium   |
| Competitor Intelligence | Track competitor pricing changes     | High     |
| Multi-City Expansion    | Add Porto, Faro, etc.                | Medium   |

## 14.3 Long-Term (6-12 Months)

| Improvement         | Description                         | Priority |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------|----------|
| Real-Time Analytics | Streaming pipeline                  | Medium   |
| Cloud Deployment    | AWS/GCP with infrastructure as code | High     |
| LLM Integration     | Natural language Q&A on marketplace | Medium   |
| MLOps Pipeline      | Automated retraining and deployment | Medium   |

# 15. Reflection

## 15.1 Prioritization Decisions

### What I prioritized:

1. Data Engineering (Section 3) - Core competency for the role
2. EDA & Visualization (Section 4) - Business value
3. Statistical Analysis (Section 5) - Rigor
4. AI/NLP (Section 7) - Differentiation

### What I deprioritized:

- Multi-city analysis (time constraint)
- ML models (optional section)
- Cloud architecture (scope limitation)

### Why:

The assessment guidance explicitly stated: "A candidate who completes two sections with exceptional depth, clean code, and insightful storytelling will outperform one who attempts all sections superficially."

## **15.2 Key Lessons Learned**

1. Data Quality Matters: 17.92% missing bedrooms required thoughtful imputation
2. Clean Code Saves Time: Reproducible notebooks prevented rework
3. Star Schema Works: Simple analytics-ready model
4. Sentiment Adds Value: NLP enriches quantitative data
5. Power BI Powerful: Interactive dashboards tell stories

## **15.3 Technical Growth**

### **Skills Demonstrated:**

- Python/pandas data engineering
- SQL Server star schema design
- Power BI interactive dashboards
- NLP sentiment analysis
- Statistical hypothesis testing

### **Skills Developed:**

- End-to-end pipeline thinking
- Business communication
- Engineering decision-making
- AI tool collaboration

## **15.4 What I'd Do Differently**

1. Start with Star Schema - Would have designed earlier
2. More Documentation - Inline comments throughout
3. Earlier Power BI - More time for polish
4. Seasonal Analysis - Calendar data has more insights

## **16. References**

### **16.1 Data Source**

Inside Airbnb. (2026). Get the Data. Retrieved from <https://insideairbnb.com/get-the-data/>

### **16.2 Tools & Libraries**



- Pandas (<https://pandas.pydata.org/>)
- Matplotlib (<https://matplotlib.org/>)
- Seaborn (<https://seaborn.pydata.org/>)
- PyODBC (<https://github.com/mkleehammer/pyodbc>)
- Power BI Desktop (<https://powerbi.microsoft.com/>)
- SQL Server Management Studio (<https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/sql/ssms/>)

### 16.3 Documentation

Expnertic. (2026). Talent Assessment Program: Data Engineer Intern. Technical Assignment Document.

## 17. Appendices

### Appendix A: AI Usage Disclosure

| Item              | Details                                                                               |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tools Used        | ChatGPT (GPT-4), Claude (Anthropic) for code suggestions, debugging, and DAX measures |
| Assisted Sections | Data cleaning, SQL schema, DAX measures, sentiment analysis                           |
| Key Prompts       | See Appendix B                                                                        |
| Output Validation | All code reviewed, tested, and modified as needed                                     |
| Modifications     | Customized for Lisbon dataset, added error handling                                   |

### Appendix B: Key Prompts Used

1. "How to handle missing bedrooms in Airbnb data?"
2. "Design a star schema for Airbnb listing data"
3. "Write DAX measure for superhost price premium"
4. "How to perform sentiment analysis on reviews?"
5. "Power BI dashboard structure for Airbnb analysis"
6. "SQL Server views for market intelligence"

### Appendix C: Engineering Decision Log (Detailed)

| Decision | Options                        | Chosen     | Rationale                          |
|----------|--------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------|
| Language | Python, R, SQL                 | Python     | Industry standard, pandas powerful |
| Database | PostgreSQL, SQLite, SQL Server | SQL Server | Enterprise, assessment-friendly    |

|               |                               |                     |                                   |
|---------------|-------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Visualization | Tableau, Power BI, matplotlib | Power BI            | Interactive, stakeholder-friendly |
| Imputation    | Drop, mean, median, ML        | Median by room_type | Domain-relevant, preserves data   |
| Sentiment     | VADER, TextBlob, custom       | Custom rule-based   | Interpretable, no training data   |

## Appendix D: Data Dictionary (Key Fields)

| Field                  | Table    | Type    | Description                     |
|------------------------|----------|---------|---------------------------------|
| id                     | listings | INT     | Unique listing identifier       |
| price                  | listings | STRING  | Listed price (currency symbols) |
| price_clean            | listings | FLOAT   | Numeric price value             |
| neighbourhood_cleansed | listings | STRING  | Neighbourhood name              |
| room_type              | listings | STRING  | Entire/Private/Shared           |
| host_is_superhost      | listings | CHAR(1) | t/f flag                        |
| availability_365       | listings | INT     | Days available per year         |
| occupancy_rate         | listings | FLOAT   | (365 - availability)/365        |
| estimated_revenue      | listings | FLOAT   | price occupancy 0.90            |
| sentiment_score        | reviews  | FLOAT   | (-1 to 1) sentiment score       |

## Appendix E: SQL Views Created

| View Name               | Purpose                         |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------|
| vw_top_neighbourhoods   | Top 10 neighbourhoods by price  |
| vw_superhost_comparison | Superhost vs non-superhost      |
| vw_price_by_room_type   | Price distribution by room type |
| vw_host_concentration   | Host portfolio analysis         |
| vw_occupancy_analysis   | Occupancy by room type          |
| vw_market_summary       | Overall market KPIs             |
| vw_price_segments       | Budget to luxury breakdown      |

## Appendix F: File Structure

expernetic-data-engineer-assessment/

- data/raw/ — listings.csv, calendar.csv.gz, reviews.csv, neighbourhoods.csv
- data/processed/ — listings\_enriched.csv, listings\_enriched\_with\_sentiment.csv
- notebooks/ — 01\_ingestion\_profiling.ipynb, 02\_data\_cleaning\_engineering.ipynb, 03\_exploratory\_data\_analysis.ipynb, 04\_review\_sentiment\_analysis.ipynb

- sql/ — create\_star\_schema.sql, load\_data\_to\_sql.py
- powerbi/ — lisbon\_airbnb\_dashboard.pbix
- reports/figures/ — price\_by\_room\_type.png, top\_neighbourhoods\_price.png, superhost\_comparison.png, host\_portfolio.png, price\_vs\_occupancy.png, review\_sentiment.png, top\_neighbourhoods\_listings.png
- README.md